

Martin Jambon

*Staff Engineer — Static Analysis,
Programming Languages, Developer Tools*

How I Work

- **Ownership:** I'm most energized when I can take responsibility for significant pieces of technology from concept to delivery.
- **First-principles thinking:** I prefer understanding problems deeply and designing solutions from the ground up when needed.
- **Technical leverage:** I gravitate toward work that produces lasting value—tools, systems, or ideas that improve how engineers work.
- **Peer collaboration:** I enjoy working alongside other experienced engineers as equals, exchanging ideas and challenging assumptions.

Suitable Roles

- Early engineer in a technically ambitious startup
- Engineer in a small advanced engineering or R&D team within a larger organization
- Engineer working on foundational developer, security, or program analysis technology

Track Record

- **Semgrep (tree-sitter integration):** Built the multi-language parsing foundation enabling scalable static analysis across languages.
- **ATD ecosystem:** Created a type definition language and tooling for generating reliable cross-language serializers and interfaces.
- **Yojson:** Original author of a widely adopted JSON library, now a standard component of the OCaml ecosystem.
- **OCaml (ocamllex warning):** Added non-exhaustive pattern detection to ocamllex in collaboration with core maintainers.

Core Expertise

- OCaml ecosystem
- CLI tool design and implementation
- Library design and implementation
- Program analysis, compilers
- Creative problem identification and problem solving
- Turning complex specs into programs that just work™

Core Engineering Principles

- **Parsimony:** Prefer simple, well-chosen designs; make common tasks easy and uncommon tasks possible.
- **Separation of concerns:** Build modular systems with clear boundaries, minimal interfaces, and well-defined layers.
- **Individual ownership:** Strong individual responsibility for outcomes, enabling fast iteration with low coordination overhead.
- **Maintainability:** Design systems that others can understand, modify, and take over without friction.
- **Exploration:** Willingness to pursue non-obvious approaches when they offer meaningful improvements.

Personal Details

- Location: Palo Alto, California
- Work authorization: US and EU (French–US citizen)
- Availability: Immediate